

The error in your command prompt is happening because **ngrok requires you to link your free account using an authentication token** before you can start a remote session.

Since you are already logged into the ngrok dashboard in your browser, fixing this is quick and easy.

Step 1: Copy your Auth Token

1. Look at the left-hand sidebar of your web browser in the background.
2. Click on the **Your Authtoken** tab (it is under the "Getting Started" section, right under "Share Localhost").
3. Copy the long string of characters (your authtoken) shown on that page.

Step 2: Authenticate the Command Prompt

Go back to your black command prompt window and run this command, pasting your copied token at the end:

```
ngrok config add-authtoken YOUR_COPIED_TOKEN_HERE
```

(Replace YOUR_COPIED_TOKEN_HERE with the actual text you copied from the website)

Step 3: Run the Port Tunnel Again

Once it says your token is saved, you can successfully open your database port to your remote team by running:

```
ngrok tcp 3306
```



Note for your Node.js code when using Ngrok:

When ngrok starts successfully, look for the **Forwarding** line in the command prompt. It will look like this:

Forwarding tcp://0.tcp.ngrok.io:12345

Because ngrok changes the port, your teammates will need to slightly adjust how they write their .env file to handle that random port number (12345).

Let me know when your **ngrok tunnel is running successfully**, and I can show you the quick **1-line change** your teammates need to make in their .env files to include that specific ngrok port!